

personal information on any website.

- Be wary of shortened or misspelled URLs that attempt to imitate legitimate ones (e.g., “paytm-secure.com” instead of “paytm.com”).
- Never enter credentials into pop-up windows, as legitimate financial institutions do not request sensitive data this way.

2. Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on all fintech accounts

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) provides an extra layer of security by requiring a second form of verification, such as an OTP (One-Time Password) or biometric authentication, making it significantly harder for hackers to gain access to your accounts.



How to protect yourself:

- Enable 2FA on all banking, investment, and fintech accounts.
- Use authenticator apps like Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator instead of SMS-based OTPs, which can be intercepted by fraudsters through SIM swapping.

3. Never share OTPs, UPI PINs, or login credentials

Scammers often pose as bank representatives, customer support agents, or even friends to trick you into sharing OTPs, UPI PINs, or login credentials. Financial institutions never ask for such details.

How to protect yourself:

- Never disclose OTPs, PINs, or passwords over phone calls, emails, or messages.
- If you receive an unexpected OTP, do not share it with anyone and report suspicious activity to your bank immediately.
- Use unique, strong passwords for different financial platforms.

4. Avoid clicking on links in unsolicited emails or messages

Phishing scams are frequently executed through emails, SMS,

and social media messages that contain fraudulent links. Clicking on these links can lead to malware installation or credential theft.

How to protect yourself:

- Avoid clicking on links from unknown sources, especially if they claim to be urgent or offer lucrative deals.
- Verify sender email addresses carefully—scammers often use addresses similar to official institutions.
- If unsure, manually type the official website address in your browser instead of clicking links.

5. Use only verified and well-reviewed fintech platforms

Scammers often create fake apps and websites that appear legitimate but are designed to steal user funds. Fraudulent fintech platforms lure victims with promises of easy loans, high investment returns, or quick transactions.

How to protect yourself:

- Download fintech apps only from official app stores like Google Play Store and Apple App Store.
- Check app ratings, user reviews, and developer details before installing.
- Research the platform's legitimacy by looking up complaints, regulatory warnings, and expert reviews.

6. Regularly monitor bank statements and transaction alerts

Unauthorized transactions often go unnoticed until it's too late. Scammers exploit this by making small, recurring deductions that accumulate over time.

How to protect yourself:

- Set up transaction alerts for all banking and fintech accounts.

